

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250277508

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

Türker; Muhammet Erkam

Telescopic Guide

Abstract

A telescopic guide (1) includes a first elongated telescopic element (2) as a base element (2a) and second elongated telescopic element (3) as an end element (3a). These two telescopic elements are arranged parallel to each other and are movable relative to each other in the longitudinal direction. The telescopic guide further includes, a plain bearing indirectly or directly between the first telescopic element (2) and the second telescopic element (3), with the proviso, that the plain bearing has a first plain bearing unit with at least one plain bearing element (26, 27, 26', 27') which can be fixed stationary to the first telescopic element (2) and is in sliding contact with the second telescopic element (3), and a second plain bearing unit has at least one plain bearing element (37) which can be fixed stationary to the second telescopic element (3), whereas it is in sliding contact with the first telescopic element (2). The plain bearing elements (26, 27, 26', 27', 37) are designed as sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies (51, 61) which have a C-shaped cross section (52, 62), and wherein a lateral opening (53, 63) is formed on the plain bearing body (51, 61) by means of the C-shaped cross section.

Inventors: Türker; Muhammet Erkam (Nörvenich, DE)

Applicant: igus GmbH (Köln, DE)

Family ID: 86329409

Appl. No.: 18/859087

Filed (or PCT Filed): April 21, 2023

PCT No.: PCT/EP2023/060505

Foreign Application Priority Data

DE 20 2022 102 165.1

Apr. 22, 2022

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: F16C29/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC F16C29/005 (20130101); F16C29/008 (20130101);

Background/Summary

[0001] The invention relates to a telescopic guide comprising a first elongated telescopic element as a base element and comprising a second elongated telescopic element as an end element, wherein these two telescopic elements are arranged parallel to each other and are movable relative to each other in the longitudinal direction, wherein a plain bearing is provided indirectly or directly between the first telescopic element and the second telescopic element, with the proviso that the plain bearing has a first plain bearing unit with at least one plain bearing element which can be fixed stationary to the first telescopic element and is in sliding contact with the second telescopic element, and a second plain bearing unit has at least one plain bearing element which can be fixed stationary to the second telescopic element, whereas it is in sliding contact with the first telescopic element.

[0002] A generic telescopic guide is known from the utility model DE 20 2018 104 466 U1. This telescopic guide has telescopic elements each with two rails running parallel. For the plain bearing of two telescopic elements four plain bearing elements are provided, of which two are fixed to the first telescopic element and are in sliding contact with the second telescopic element and two plain bearing elements are fixed to the second telescopic element and are in sliding contact with the first telescopic element.

[0003] The known structure provides several so-called sliding guide surfaces in order to provide the telescopic mobility of the telescopic elements relative to each other. The design of the plain bearing elements, which are all to be structurally identical, is characteristic of this state of the art. That is to say only a single type of plain bearing element is used universally. The universal plain bearing element is used both on the left and on the right of the double rail and moreover must be fixable either to the first telescopic element or to the second telescopic element. Suitable fixing means must be provided twice for this purpose, which is realized in the form of two recesses which have to cooperate with a separate clamping element. In the fixed state on the telescopic element the applied clamping element forms a raised shape, which fits into one of the recesses of the plain bearing element in a positive-locking manner. The clamping element can be, e.g., a set screw, which can be screwed onto the telescopic element.

[0004] The known telescopic guide is considered to protrude too much spatially and to be structurally too elaborate. The universal sliding element is regarded as too complex. In addition, the application of the clamping elements to the telescopic elements is labour-intensive. In particular, if there is a set screw present as clamping element which has to be screwed into the telescopic element parallel to the longitudinal extent. A large amount of effort is expended in order to screw the required number of set screws onto the respective telescopic element in the necessary position.

[0005] The object of the invention is to propose a more compact telescopic guide which can be produced with smaller material outlay, requires less installation space and is easier to mount.

[0006] According to the invention, the object is achieved in that the plain bearing elements are designed as sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies which have a C-shaped cross section, and in that a lateral opening is formed on the plain bearing body by means of the C-shaped cross section.

[0007] The novel sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies with the C-shaped cross section eliminate the complexity of the known plain bearing body. The significantly smaller space requirement for the

plain bearing bodies is accompanied by the fact that the design of the telescopic elements is also simplified, they are constructed more compact and overall less material is required. The proposed telescopic guide is easier to mount and easier to handle.

[0008] The C-shaped cross section of the sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies always brings about a positive-locking connection together with and relative to the two telescopic elements involved.

[0009] The plain bearing thus provided absorbs forces from all directions in the cross-sectional plane of the plain bearing bodies.

[0010] Each sleeve-shaped plain bearing body expediently has an inner contour and an outer contour, wherein the inner contour and the outer contour extend in an axial direction of the plain bearing body, and wherein the inner contour and the outer contour are arranged concentric to each other. This design promotes the compactness of the plain bearing bodies.

[0011] The inner contour of the plain bearing body advantageously has a polygonal cross section and the cross section is preferably square. The polygonal design promotes the fulfilling of a supporting and guiding function in cooperation with the telescopic elements involved.

[0012] It is likewise useful if the outer contour of the plain bearing body has a polygonal or circular cross section. The polygonal design of the outer contour can promote a supporting and guiding function well in cooperation with the telescopic elements involved, whereas a circular cross section is favourable provided that no torque has to be absorbed.

[0013] The invention in particular provides two types of plain bearing elements, which have differently designed plain bearing bodies. A differentiated structure is provided instead of a universal plain bearing element. Each type of plain bearing element/plain bearing body has only those functional features which are required during operation.

[0014] The first type of plain bearing body is favourably designed such that its inner contour is set up as a plain bearing surface and its outer contour is formed with a fixing means for the stationary fixing to a telescopic element.

[0015] In addition, it is useful if the second type of plain bearing body is designed such that its outer contour is set up as a plain bearing surface and its inner contour is formed with a fixing means for the stationary fixing to a telescopic element.

[0016] The structure of both types of plain bearing bodies differs in the arrangement of the plain bearing surfaces, which are provided either on the inner contour or on the outer contour. Along with this the respectively other contour (inner or outer contour) serves for fixing the plain bearing body to one of the telescopic elements. A universal design of a single type of plain bearing element or plain bearing body is dispensed with.

[0017] The telescopic elements are expediently provided with complementary means which are set up to cooperate with a fixing means of a plain bearing body.

[0018] It is helpful, for example for the mounting, if the opening of the C-shaped cross section of the plain bearing body can be temporarily enlarged by means of elastic deformation of the plain bearing body.

[0019] A further usefulness is seen if the first elongated telescopic element provided as the base element is provided with a supporting rail, and that the supporting rail has either a cross section with a raised rail head or a cross section with a rail channel.

[0020] It is also advantageous if the second elongated telescopic element provided as the end element is provided with a sliding rail, wherein the sliding rail, complementary to the supporting rail of the first elongated telescopic element, has either a cross section with a raised rail head or a cross section with a rail channel.

[0021] In principle, the supporting rail in each case cooperates with the sliding rail in such a way that these two are movable translationally relative to each other. Expediently, the supporting rail is static and bears the load and the sliding rail moves on the supporting rail. For this purpose, both complementary rails have cross sections such as, for example, the raised rail head mentioned and the rail channel. The rail head is preferably provided on the supporting rail directed upwards and

the rail channel is on the sliding rail with the opening of the channel cross section directed downwards. It is expedient if the rail head and the rail channel are not directly in contact, but rather a plain bearing is provided between these two, which can be provided in the form of the described two types of plain bearing bodies.

[0022] The area of application can be improved if the cross section of the rail channel surrounds/envelops the cross section of the allocated rail head in a positive-locking manner in such a way that the rail channel cannot be laterally or upwardly separated from the rail head. The rail head and the rail channel can be separated by reciprocal displacement in the longitudinal direction.

[0023] In order to provide the positive-locking envelopment, the rail channel expediently surrounds the rail element in a circumferential range of from 200° to 320° , preferably 270° to 300° , particularly preferably 280° to 290° . If a plain bearing element is interposed, the enveloped circumferential range of the rail channel around the rail head and the enveloped circumferential range of the plain bearing element around the rail head are then identical or almost identical.

[0024] A further usefulness is seen if the cross section of the raised rail head is designed complementary to the inner contour of the plain bearing bodies and the cross section of the rail channel is designed complementary to the outer contour of the plain bearing bodies. Through this measure the supporting rail and the sliding rail in each case act, with their raised rail heads or with the rail channels, respectively, as a supporting base for the holder for the plain bearing bodies. The plain bearing bodies in this way obtain a support and guide.

[0025] A further usefulness is seen if in each case the first type of plain bearing body, the outer contour of which is provided with the fixing means that serves for the stationary fixing to the respective telescopic element, can be applied to a telescopic element which comprises a supporting rail with a raised rail head or a sliding rail with a raised rail head.

[0026] Equally, it is useful if in each case the second type of plain bearing body, the inner contour of which is provided with the fixing means which serves for the stationary fixing to the respective telescopic element, can be applied to a telescopic element which comprises a supporting rail with a rail channel or a sliding rail with a rail channel.

[0027] The area of application of the proposed telescopic guide can be expanded if at least one third elongated telescopic element is provided as an intermediate element. The intermediate element is to be viewed as a second telescopic element in relation to the base element, which represents the first telescopic element. In relation to the end element, on the other hand, the intermediate element can be referred to as the first telescopic element, which then serves as a base for the end element as the second telescopic element.

[0028] It is helpful if the intermediate element comprises a sliding rail which cooperates with the supporting rail of the base element and the intermediate element for its part comprises a supporting rail which cooperates with the sliding rail of the end element.

[0029] The intermediate element further designed in this way can be connected in a positive-locking and sliding manner to the base element and in a positive-locking and sliding manner to the end element. Moreover, two or more intermediate elements can be connected one above the other, with the result that they can cooperate in a positive-locking and sliding manner. In this way, the telescopic guide can be expanded by further telescopic elements in the form of intermediate elements.

[0030] An additional improvement is achieved if the telescopic elements are in each case formed as a double rail, wherein the double rail has two parallel supporting rails and/or two parallel sliding rails.

[0031] For an intermediate element formed as a double rail it is expediently provided to arrange two double rails one above the other, of which one is designed with parallel sliding rails and is facing towards the base element and the other is designed with parallel supporting rails and is facing towards the end element.

[0032] Advantageously, in the case of a double rail, a lateral guiding can be brought about in each

case between one of the parallel rails (supporting rail or sliding rail) and the allocated plain bearing bodies, whereas a lateral play (air) is provided between the plain bearing bodies of the other of the parallel rails.

[0033] The base element is expediently provided with a stand. The telescopic guide can thus be installed lying (horizontally). However, it can also be installed upright (vertically). Drawer runners are a possible application.

[0034] In addition, the base element can have two side elements, wherein the side elements expediently have a height which is sufficient to enclose the telescopic element(s) arranged above them laterally. Such side elements serve at least for mechanical protection and can prevent contamination.

[0035] Furthermore, it is useful if at least one of the side elements is formed as a closed side wall. This improves the protection from contamination of the interior of the telescopic guide.

[0036] For the end element, it is helpful if it has a mounting plane for any attachments.

[0037] The mounting plane can beneficially be a closed surface. The interior of the telescopic guide can thereby be protected from contamination.

[0038] At least one of the telescopic elements is expediently formed in a single piece, preferably of metal, particularly preferably of aluminium or an aluminium alloy. Aluminium or an aluminium alloy can be produced by extrusion moulding. This size accuracy and dimensional accuracy as well as the quality of the thus-achievable surfaces are sufficient for telescopic elements. In particular, the areas of extrusion-moulded telescopic elements that are required as sliding surfaces also have sufficient size and dimensional stability as well as sufficient surface quality. The aluminium material expediently has an anodized surface.

[0039] All telescopic elements of the telescopic guide preferably have a uniform overall length. An extension length, which is a fraction of this overall length, is provided between two telescopic elements. This extension length preferably lies in a range of 30%-70% of the overall length, preferably 50% of the overall length of a telescopic element.

[0040] The sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies, with their lateral opening, can be produced from plastic, preferably in the form of polymer sliding material, particularly preferably from such a sliding material with a reinforcing filler, such as fibres of plastic or textile.

[0041] By a sliding material is meant in the present case a polymer material which has a lower coefficient of friction than the surface of the telescopic element that serves as sliding surface. In particular, this includes the thermoplastics polyethylene, polypropylene, polyacetal, polycarbonate, polyamide, polyvinyl chloride, polytetrafluoroethylene as well as, in the case of thermosets, phenolic resins. To further reduce the friction, these plastics can contain lubricants, in particular fine-particle solid lubricants such as molybdenum disulfide or graphite. Such polymers are also referred to as tribopolymers. With the friction, the wear reduces and the abrasion becomes less. These products are therefore advisable particularly when high purity is important. This is the case for example in the food industry and semiconductor industry, as well as in biochemical and microbiological applications. As mentioned, these polymer materials can furthermore contain fillers and fibrous materials, for example those made of plastic or textile, which improve the mechanical properties.

[0042] The proposed telescopic guide can be made very solidly, in particular, when a combination of plastic and aluminium materials is used.

[0043] The telescopic elements are more commonly subject to bending in use. For this reason, they are produced from a material which has a high bending stiffness, preferably from a metal, such as the aluminium material mentioned.

[0044] In an application as a drawer runner installed upright, it has been shown in a laboratory test that two telescopic guides with an extension length of 400 mm in close proximity withstand a static load of up to 180 N.

[0045] Through the use of aluminium material, the telescopic guide benefits from an even further

reduced overall weight. In addition, it has a very good resistance to corrosion. Its plain bearing does not require a lubricant. Because lubricants are dispensed with, dirt cannot adhere to components of the telescopic guide, which promotes operational reliability. Any dirt lying thereon can be removed with high-pressure cleaners and/or using cleaning agents. The telescopic guide is therefore low-maintenance and cost-effective.

[0046] The invention is illustrated by way of example in a drawing and described in detail with reference to several figures below. There are shown in:

[0047] FIG. 1 a front view of a first embodiment example of the telescopic guide according to the invention with two telescopic elements,

[0048] FIG. 2a a schematic side view of the telescopic guide according to FIG. 1 in the retracted state,

[0049] FIG. 2b a schematic side view of the telescopic guide according to FIG. 1 in a partially extended state,

[0050] FIG. 2c a schematic side view of the telescopic guide according to FIG. 1 in the maximally extended state,

[0051] FIG. 3 a front view of a second embodiment example of the telescopic guide according to the invention with three telescopic elements,

[0052] FIG. 4 a perspective view of the rear side of the second embodiment example without the upper telescopic element,

[0053] FIG. 5 a perspective view of a plain bearing element with a sleeve-shaped plain bearing body, which has inwardly lying plain bearing surfaces and outwardly lying positive-locking fixing means,

[0054] FIG. 6 a perspective section of a telescopic element with complementary means, which are set up for the external fixing means of the plain bearing element according to FIG. 5,

[0055] FIG. 7 a perspective view of a plain bearing element with a sleeve-shaped plain bearing body, which has outwardly lying plain bearing surfaces and inwardly lying positive-locking fixing means,

[0056] FIG. 8 a perspective section of a telescopic element with complementary means, which are set up for the internal fixing means of the plain bearing element according to FIG. 7,

[0057] FIG. 9 a detail view according to IX in FIG. 3,

[0058] FIG. 10 a detail view according to X in FIG. 9,

[0059] FIG. 11 a detail view according to XI in FIG. 3,

[0060] FIG. 12 a detail view according to XII in FIG. 11,

[0061] FIG. 13 a third embodiment example of the telescopic guide according to the invention with two telescopic elements,

[0062] FIG. 14 a fourth embodiment example of the telescopic guide according to the invention with three telescopic elements.

Description

[0063] FIG. 1 shows a first embodiment example of the telescopic guide 1 according to the invention, namely a view from the front. According to this, the telescopic guide 1 comprises two elongated telescopic elements 2 and 3, namely a base element 2a arranged at the bottom and an end element 3a arranged above it which forms the second elongated telescopic element 3. These two telescopic elements are arranged parallel to each other and are movable relative to each other in a longitudinal direction. The longitudinal direction runs orthogonal relative to the plane of this front view.

[0064] The telescopic elements 2 and 3 of this embodiment example are in each case formed as a double rail 4 and 5, respectively. The base element 2 is constructed symmetrically. It is provided

with a stand **6**, which has symmetrical base plates **7** and **8**, side walls **9** and **10** and upper ledges **11** and **12**. The base plates serve to position or mount the telescopic guide **1** on a surface. Furthermore, the base element **2a** has two supporting rails **13** and **14**, which are directed upwards relative to the stand **6**. The supporting rails **13** and **14** cooperate with sliding rails **15** and **16** of the end element **3a**. For this purpose, the supporting rails are in each case provided with a quadrilateral cross section, which forms a raised rail head **15** and **16**, respectively. The supporting rail **13** is connected to the side wall **9** of the base element **2a** by means of a holding bar **19**. The holding bar **19** has a lower crosspiece **20**, on which a holding piece **21** is arranged reaching upwards. The holding piece **21** is provided with an inclined holding arm **22**, on which the quadrilateral cross section of the rail head **17** is formed. Furthermore, the holding bar **19** has a central piece **23**, which is arranged parallel to the side wall **9** of the base element **2a** and at an upper end has an upper connecting bar **24** which reaches to the side wall **9** of the base element **2a**. The upper connecting bar **24** meets the side wall **9** orthogonally and lies slightly higher than the quadrilateral cross section of the rail head **17**. The holding bar **19** is formed in a single piece with the supporting rail **13** and the base element **2a**. The supporting rail **14** of the other side is likewise formed in a single piece with the base element **2a** by means of a symmetrically constructed holding bar **25**.

[0065] A plain bearing element **26** sits on the rail head **17** and a plain bearing element **27** sits on the other rail head **18**. Each of the plain bearing elements **26/27** for its part has a quadrilateral inner contour and has a circular outer contour. The plain bearing elements **26/27** are identical. In principle, however, two different types of plain bearing elements are provided, which are described in detail further below with reference to FIG. 5 and FIG. 7.

[0066] It can furthermore be seen with reference to FIG. 1 that the two sliding rails **15** and **16** of the end element **3a** are implemented as sliding channel **28** and sliding channel **29** respectively.

[0067] The rail head **18** of the supporting rail **14** is formed slightly narrower than the rail head **17** of the supporting rail **13**. The rail head **18** thereby maintains a certain lateral play **S1** (air). The rail head **17** of the supporting rail **13**, together with the allocated plain bearing elements **26**, therefore undertakes the lateral guiding, while the rail head **18** of the supporting rail **14** can compensate, to some extent, for any dimensional deviations in the gauge of the double rail and/or any deviations from the ideal parallelism of the supporting rails. In the case of a horizontal use of the proposed telescopic guide, the rail head **18** together with the supporting rail **14** can bear a portion of an applied load, but without providing lateral guiding.

[0068] The end element **3a** is provided right at the top with a mounting plane **30**, for example a flat mounting surface **30a**. The mounting surface **30a** is formed on a bar **31** which connects the two sliding rails **15/16**. The cross section of the bar **31** has a certain material thickness and is designed symmetrically. The bar **31** has the largest material thickness in the middle. A decrease in the material thickness towards both sides is preferably provided. The decrease in the material thickness is particularly preferably affected symmetrically in steps **32** and **33**, respectively.

[0069] The base element **2a** is likewise provided with a bar **34**. This bar **34** connects the two supporting rails **13/14**. This bar **34** also has a cross section with a material thickness which is largest in the middle. A decrease in the material thickness towards both sides is preferably provided. Here too, the decrease in the material thickness is particularly preferably affected in steps **35** and **36**, respectively.

[0070] FIGS. 2a-2c each show a schematic side view of the telescopic guide **1** according to FIG. 1 implemented as a double rail. The telescopic guide is represented in the retracted state according to FIG. 2a as well as partially extended in FIG. 2b and in the maximally extended state by means of FIG. 2c.

[0071] FIG. 2a shows the two elongated telescopic elements **2** and **3** in the retracted state. That is to say the shortest possible overall length $L_{\text{sub.min}}$ of the telescopic guide **1**. The lower telescopic element **2** is the base element **2a** and the upper telescopic element **3** is the end element **3a**. Two plain bearing elements **26** and **37**, which are allocated to one rail side of the double rail, are

represented in their longitudinal extent, i.e., the telescopic guide has four plain bearing elements in total. A fixing means **26a**, with which the plain bearing element **26** is fixed to the telescopic element **3**, is represented symbolically. In contrast thereto, the plain bearing element **37** is fixed to the telescopic element **2** (base element **2a**) by means of a fixing means **37a**. In this way, the plain bearing element **26** is movable together with the upper telescopic element **3**, i.e., with the end element **3a**.

[0072] Furthermore, the end element **3a** is provided with a stop means **38**, which cooperates with a stop bar **39** which is provided on the base element **2a**.

[0073] According to FIG. **2b**, the upper telescopic element **3** is partially extended by the distance **D**. The plain bearing element **26** fixed thereto has moved with it by the same distance and the stop means **38** has shortened the distance from the stop bar **39**.

[0074] In FIG. **2c**, the telescopic guide **1**, or respectively the telescopic element **3**, is extended by the maximum extension length **D.sub.max**. The stop means **38** has come into contact with the stop bar **39** and in this way limits the extension length to this maximum. Without such a limitation the extension length could reach further until the plain bearing elements **26** and **37** bump into each other. This is possible in principle but tends to be avoided for stability reasons. For the sake of safety, a certain bending strength of the entire telescopic guide **1** is guaranteed by means of the proposed limitation. In the example shown, the maximum extension length **D.sub.max** corresponds to approximately 50% of the shortest possible overall length **L.sub.min** of the telescopic guide **1** shown in FIG. **2a**.

[0075] FIG. **3** shows a front view of a second embodiment example of the telescopic guide according to the invention. The second embodiment comprises three telescopic elements. The upper telescopic element **3** is provided as end element **3a**. It is identical to that of FIG. **1**. The lower telescopic element **2** provided as base element **2a** that has higher side walls **9'** and **10'** compared with FIG. **1** and a larger overall height **H** than that of FIG. **1**. For the rest, however, it is identical to FIG. **1**. For the upper and lower telescopic elements **2** and **3**, in FIG. **3** identical features are marked with the same reference numbers as in FIG. **1**. An additional third telescopic element **40** is formed as an intermediate element **40a**. It cooperates in a sliding manner with the base element **2a** located underneath and with the end element **3a** located above. Again, all three telescopic elements are in each case formed as a double rail. In order that the intermediate element **40a** can cooperate with the neighbouring telescopic elements **2** and **3** above and below, it is for its part provided with two double rails **41** and **42** arranged one above the other. Its lower double rail **42** has parallel sliding rails **43** and **44** which cooperate with the supporting rails of the base element **2a**, whereas the upper double rail **41** is provided with parallel supporting rails **45** and **46** which cooperate with the sliding rails **15** and **16** of the end element **3a**. A plain bearing element **26** is provided on the rail head **17** of the supporting rail **13** and a rail head of the supporting rail **45** of the intermediate element **40a** is provided with a plain bearing element **26'** of the same type. The other symmetry side of the intermediate element **40a** is provided with plain bearing elements **27** and **27'**.

[0076] The intermediate element **40a** is provided with a symmetrically constructed bar **47**. The bar **47** is arranged at the top, with the result that its upper side **48** reaches beyond the supporting rails **45/46** of the intermediate element **40a**. It connects two symmetrical side areas **49** and **50** of the intermediate element **40a**. The side area **49** comprises the sliding rail **43** and, arranged above it, the supporting rail **45**. The sliding rail **44** and, above it, the supporting rail **46** are provided in the side area **50**. The supporting rails **45/46** belong to the upper double rail **41** of the intermediate element **40a** and they are designed as raised rail heads, the design of which matches the design of the raised rail heads **13/14** of the base element of FIG. **1**, to which reference is made. The sliding rails **43** and **44** belong to the lower double rail **42** of the intermediate element **40a** and they are designed as rail channels, the design of which matches the design of the rail channels **15/16** of the end element **3a**, which is identical to the end element **3a** of FIG. **1**. The mentioned bar **47** of the intermediate element **40a** has three areas **47a** with constant material thickness. Two areas **47b** with a larger

material thickness **47b** are provided in between.

[0077] FIG. **4** shows a perspective view of the rear side of the second embodiment example of FIG. **3**, wherein, however, only two of its telescopic elements are shown, namely the base element **2a** and the intermediate element **40a**. The end element has been omitted in this representation. In the perspective view, the intermediate element **40a** is drawn in an extended position relative to the base element **2a**. Because the rear side is shown here, the supporting rail **14** with the narrower rail head **18** is located on the left in the illustration. The gap **S1** results on this side of the double rail. For the rest, the plain bearing element **27** is fixed in the sliding rail **44** and is moved with it in a sliding manner when the intermediate element **40a** retracts or extends.

[0078] The details of the above-mentioned two different types of plain bearing element are described in detail below with reference to FIG. **5** and FIG. **7**. FIG. **5** shows the type of plain bearing element **26** which can be seen in FIG. **4**.

[0079] The plain bearing element **26** is contained in FIGS. **1-3**. According to FIG. **5**, it is designed as a first type of sleeve-shaped plain bearing body **51** and has a C-shaped cross section **52**. An opening **53** is formed on the side of the plain bearing body **51**. An inner contour **54** is also provided, which extends in an axial direction M of the plain bearing body **51**. Likewise, an outer contour **55** extends in the direction of a centre axis M. The inner contour **54** and outer contour **55** are arranged concentric to each other and to a centre axis M, which creates a compact design of this plain bearing element **26**.

[0080] The inner contour **54** of the plain bearing body **51** has a square cross section **56**, whereby four inner bearing surfaces **56a**, **56b**, **56c** and **56d** result. Fillet-shaped depressions **57a**, **57b**, **57c** are provided at the corners of adjoining inner bearing surfaces. The inner contour **54** is interrupted by the lateral opening **53** of the plain bearing body **51**, wherein despite the interruption the cross section of the inner contour **54** is referred to, simplified, as square within the meaning of this invention. The concentrically arranged outer contour **55** has a circular cross section **58**, which is likewise interrupted and despite that is referred to, simplified, as circular, or the outer contour **55** is referred to as cylindrical.

[0081] In the case of the plain bearing element **26** of FIG. **5**, the inner contour **54** serves as a plain bearing surface, or respectively the four inner bearing surfaces **56a**, **56b**, **56c** and **56d** serve for the plain bearing.

[0082] The outer contour **55** is provided with a fixing means which, in the built-in state, cooperates in a positive-locking manner with a telescopic element. According to FIG. **5** the fixing means comprises ribs **59a**, **59b** and **59c**, which protrude from the cylindrical outer contour **55** in the radial direction.

[0083] FIG. **6** shows, by means of a perspective section on the third telescopic element **40** (intermediate element **40a**), a location which is provided with a complementary means which cooperates with the fixing means of the plain bearing element **26** of FIG. **5**. The sliding rail **43**, which is formed as a rail channel **28** with C-shaped cross section, can be seen.

[0084] The complementary means comprises a groove-like recess **60** in the rail channel **28**. The recess **60** is formed to fit the radial ribs **59a-59c** of the plain bearing element **26** of FIG. **5**. In this way, when it is moved translationally, the telescopic element **40** can move the positive-locking plain bearing element **26** with it, as can be seen in FIG. **4**.

[0085] FIG. **7** shows the second type of plain bearing element **37**. The plain bearing element **37** is contained in FIGS. **2a-c**. It is designed as a second type of sleeve-shaped plain bearing body **61** and has a C-shaped cross section **62**. Here too, an opening **63** is formed on the side of the plain bearing body thereof. An inner contour **64** is likewise provided, which extends in the direction of a centre axis N of the plain bearing body **61**, as well as an outer contour **65** which extends in the same direction.

[0086] The inner contour **64** and the outer contour **65** are arranged concentric relative to a centre axis N, with the result that this plain bearing element **37** also has a compact design.

[0087] The inner contour **64** has a square cross section **66**, whereby four inner surfaces **66a**, **66b**, **66c** and **66d** result. Fillet-shaped depressions **67a**, **67b** and **67c** are provided at the corners of adjoining inner surfaces. However, the inner surfaces do not act as plain bearing surfaces. Instead, the inner contour **64** is provided with a fixing means which, in the built-in state, cooperates in a positive-locking manner with a telescopic element. According to FIG. 7 the fixing means comprises ribs, of which the two ribs **68a** and **68b** are visible. They project inwards from the relevant inner surface **66a** and **66b**.

[0088] FIG. 8 shows, by means of a perspective section on the first telescopic element **2** (base element **2a**), a location which is provided with a complementary means which cooperates with the fixing means of the plain bearing element **37** of FIG. 7. The supporting rail **14**, which is formed as a raised rail head **18** with quadrilateral cross section, can be seen.

[0089] The raised rail head **18** is provided with a groove-shaped recess **69**, with which the raised ribs of the plain bearing element **37** fit together in a positive-locking manner. In this way, the plain bearing element **37** is fixed to the base element **2a**. The cylindrical outer contour of the plain bearing element **37** serves as a plain bearing surface when it cooperates with a sliding rail.

[0090] FIG. 9 shows a detail view according to IX in FIG. 3. The plain bearing element **26**, which corresponds to that in FIG. 5, can be seen. The plain bearing element **26** has a square cross section **56** and on its inner contour **54** is provided with inner bearing surfaces **56a-d** which rest in a sliding manner on the rail head of the supporting rail **45** of the intermediate element **40a**. The cylindrical outer contour **55** of the plain bearing element **26** is fitted in the sliding rail **15** of the end element **3a**, which is formed as a rail channel **28**. The outer contour **55** has four radially protruding ribs **59a-d**, which fit in a positive-locking manner into a recess **60** of the rail channel **28**. The plain bearing element **26** thus slides on the rail head of the supporting rail **45** of the intermediate element **40a**. The rail head has plain bearing surfaces **70a-d**. The rail channel has a C-shaped cross section with an opening **71** directed substantially downwards, which coincides with the lateral opening **53** of the plain bearing element **26**. The inside of the rail channel is matched to the cylindrical outer contour **55** of the plain bearing element **26**. In the built-in state, the lateral opening **53** and the opening **71** leave space for the one holding arm of the intermediate element **40a** which is arranged at an angle and which connects the quadrilateral cross section of the rail head of the supporting rail **45** to the intermediate element **40a** in a single piece.

[0091] FIG. 10 shows a detail view according to X in FIG. 9. The view is a longitudinal section through the sliding rail **15** with plain bearing element **26** fixed therein. On its outer contour **55** the latter has fixing means in the form of the radial ribs **59a** and **59c**, with which it is fixed in a positive-locking manner in the sliding rail **15**. The ribs **59a** and **59c** protrude radially on the outer contour **55** of the plain bearing element **26**. The inner contour **54** of the plain bearing element **26** forms plain bearing surfaces **56a** and **56c**, which are arranged on the rail head of the supporting rail **45** and can slide thereon.

[0092] FIG. 11 shows a detail view according to XI in FIG. 3. The plain bearing element **37**, which corresponds to that in FIG. 7, can be seen. This plain bearing element **37** sits, with the square cross section of its inner contour **64** which has four inner surfaces **66a-d**, on the rail head **17** of the supporting rail **13** of the base element **2a**. Its cylindrical outer contour **65** is fitted in the sliding rail **43** of the intermediate element **40a**, which is formed as a rail channel. Here, the inner contour **64** of the plain bearing element **37** is provided with four ribs **68a-d**, which project inwards and fit in a positive-locking manner into a recess **69**, which is represented by way of example on the quadrilateral cross section of the rail head **18** according to FIG. 12. An identical recess is provided for the supporting rail **13** and the rail head **17**. The sliding movement takes place between the sliding rail **43** of the intermediate element and the cylindrical outer contour **65** of the plain bearing element **37** which is fixed to the supporting rail **13** of the base element **2a**.

[0093] FIG. 12 shows a detail view according to XII in FIG. 11. This view is a longitudinal section through the sliding rail **43** with the plain bearing element **37** fixed therein. On its inner contour **64**

this plain bearing element has fixing means in the form of ribs **68a** and **68c**, which project inwards and are in a positive-locking manner with a groove-shaped recess, such as the recess **69** in FIG. **11**. The plain bearing element **37** is thus fixed in a positive-locking manner to the supporting rail **13**. Here, the cylindrical outer contour **65** forms a cylindrical plain bearing surface on which the sliding rail **43** can slide.

[0094] FIG. **13** shows a third embodiment example of the telescopic guide **1** according to the invention, which in turn comprises two telescopic elements **72** and **73**, a base element **72a** and an end element **73a**. Unlike the first embodiment example, the telescopic elements of which are implemented as a double rail, however, FIG. **13** provides telescopic elements in the form of individual rails. For the rest, the structure matches one symmetry side of the embodiment example of FIG. **1**.

[0095] FIG. **14** shows a fourth embodiment example of the telescopic guide **1** according to the invention, which like FIG. **3** is provided with three telescopic elements **74**, **75** and **76**, a base element **74a**, an intermediate element **75a** and an end element **76a**. Unlike the first embodiment example, the telescopic elements of which are in each case implemented as a double rail, FIG. **14** involves three telescopic elements in the form of individual rails. For the rest, the structure matches one symmetry side of the embodiment example of FIG. **3**.

LIST OF REFERENCE NUMBERS

[0096] **1** telescopic guide [0097] **2** telescopic element [0098] **2a** base element [0099] **3** telescopic element [0100] **3a** end element [0101] **4** double rail [0102] **5** double rail [0103] **6** stand [0104] **7** base plate [0105] **8** base plate [0106] **9** side wall [0107] **9'** side wall [0108] **10** side wall [0109] **10'** side wall [0110] **11** upper ledge [0111] **12** upper ledge [0112] **13** supporting rail [0113] **14** supporting rail [0114] **15** sliding rail [0115] **16** sliding rail [0116] **17** rail head [0117] **18** rail head [0118] **19** holding bar [0119] **20** crosspiece [0120] **21** holding piece [0121] **22** holding arm [0122] **23** central piece [0123] **24** connecting bar [0124] **25** holding bar [0125] **26** plain bearing element [0126] **26a** fixing means [0127] **26'** plain bearing element [0128] **27** plain bearing element [0129] **27'** plain bearing element [0130] **28** rail channel [0131] **29** rail channel [0132] **30** mounting plane [0133] **30a** mounting surface [0134] **31** bar [0135] **32** step [0136] **33** step [0137] **34** bar [0138] **35** step [0139] **36** step [0140] **37** plain bearing element [0141] **37a** fixing means [0142] **38** stop means [0143] **39** stop bar [0144] **40** telescopic element [0145] **40a** intermediate element [0146] **41** double rail [0147] **42** double rail [0148] **43** sliding rail [0149] **44** sliding rail [0150] **45** supporting rail [0151] **46** supporting rail [0152] **47** bar [0153] **47a** area [0154] **47b** area [0155] **48** upper side [0156] **49** side area [0157] **50** side area [0158] **51** plain bearing body [0159] **52** C-shaped cross section [0160] **53** lateral opening [0161] **54** inner contour [0162] **55** outer contour [0163] **56a-d** inner bearing surface [0164] **57** fillet-shaped depression [0165] **58a-c** circular cross section [0166] **59a-c** rib (radial) [0167] **60** groove-shaped recess [0168] **61** plain bearing body [0169] **62** C-shaped cross section [0170] **63** lateral opening [0171] **64** inner contour [0172] **65** outer contour [0173] **66a-d** inner surface [0174] **67a-c** fillet-shaped depression [0175] **68a/b** rib [0176] **69** groove-shaped recess [0177] **70a-d** plain bearing surface [0178] **71** opening [0179] **72** telescopic element [0180] **72a** base element [0181] **73** telescopic element [0182] **73a** end element [0183] **74** telescopic element [0184] **74a** base element [0185] **75** telescopic element [0186] **75a** intermediate element [0187] **76** telescopic element [0188] **76a** end element [0189] **D** distance [0190] **D.sub.max** extension length [0191] **H** overall height [0192] **L.sub.min** overall length (shortest) [0193] **M** centre axis [0194] **S1** play

Claims

1. A telescopic guide (**1**) comprising a first elongated telescopic element (**2**) as a base element (**2a**) and second elongated telescopic element (**3**) as an end element (**3a**), and wherein these two telescopic elements are arranged parallel to each other and are movable relative to each other in a

longitudinal direction, wherein a plain bearing is provided indirectly or directly between the first telescopic element (2) and the second telescopic element (3), wherein the plain bearing has a first plain bearing unit with at least one plain bearing element (26, 27, 26', 27') which can be fixed stationary to the first telescopic element (2) and is in sliding contact with the second telescopic element (3), and a second plain bearing unit with at least one plain bearing element (37) which can be fixed stationary to the second telescopic element (3), whereas the second plain bearing unit is in sliding contact with the first telescopic element (2), wherein the plain bearing elements (26, 27, 26', 27', 37) are sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies (51, 61) which have a C-shaped cross section (52, 62), and in that a lateral opening (53, 63) is formed on the plain bearing body (51, 61) by the C-shaped cross section.

2. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 1, wherein each sleeve-shaped plain bearing body (51, 61) has an inner contour (54, 64) and an outer contour (55, 65), wherein the inner contour and the outer contour (55, 65) extend in an axial direction of the plain bearing body (51, 61), and wherein the inner contour (54, 64) and the outer contour (55, 65) are arranged concentric to each other.

3. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 2, wherein the inner contour (54, 64) of the plain bearing body (51, 61) has a polygonal cross section.

4. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 2, wherein the outer contour (55, 65) of the plain bearing body (51, 61) has a polygonal or circular cross section.

5. The telescopic guide according to claim 1, wherein two types of plain bearing elements are provided, which have differently designed plain bearing bodies (51, 61).

6. The telescopic guide according to claim 5, wherein the first type of plain bearing body (51) includes an inner contour (54) with a plain bearing surface and an outer contour (55) having a fixing means (59a, 59b, 59c, 59d) for a stationary fixing to one of the telescopic elements (2, 3, 40, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76).

7. The telescopic guide according to claim 6, wherein the second type of plain bearing body (61) includes an outer contour (65) with a plain bearing surface and an inner contour (64) having a fixing means (68a, 68b, 68c, 68d) for a stationary fixing to one of the telescopic elements (2, 3, 40, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76).

8. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 7, wherein the telescopic elements (2, 3, 40, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76) have complementary means (60, 69) which are set up to cooperate with the fixing means (59a, 59b, 59c, 59d, 68a, 68b, 68c, 68d) of the plain bearing body (51, 61).

9. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 1, wherein the opening (53, 63) of the C-shaped cross section (52, 62) of the plain bearing body (51, 61) can be temporarily enlarged by deformation of the plain bearing body (51, 61).

10. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 1, wherein the first elongated telescopic element (2, 72, 74) provided as the base element (2a, 72a, 74a) includes a supporting rail, and the supporting rail (13, 14, 45, 46) has either a cross section with a raised rail head (17, 18) or a cross section with a rail channel (28, 29).

11. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 10, wherein the second elongated telescopic element (3, 73, 76) provided as the end element (3a, 73a, 76a) includes a sliding rail (15, 16, 43, 44), and the sliding rail (15, 16, 43, 44) is complementary to the supporting rail (13, 14, 45, 46) of the first elongated telescopic element (2, 40) and has either a cross section with a raised rail head (17, 18) or a cross section with a rail channel (28, 29).

12. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 11, wherein the cross section of the raised rail head (17, 18) is complementary to an inner contour (54, 64) of the plain bearing bodies (51, 61) and a cross section of the rail channel (28, 29) is complementary to an outer contour (55, 65) of the plain bearing bodies (51, 61).

13. The telescopic guide (1) according to claim 12, wherein in each case a first type of the plain bearing body (51); having the outer contour (55) of which is provided with a fixing means (59a,

59b, 59c, 59d) that serves for a stationary fixing to the respective telescopic element (**3, 40**), can be applied to the telescopic element (**2, 40**) which has the supporting rail (**13, 14, 45, 46**) with the raised rail head (**17, 18**) or the sliding rail with the raised rail head.

14. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 13, wherein in each case a second type of the plain bearing body (**61**) having the inner contour (**54**) of which is provided with a fixing means (**59a, 59b, 59c, 59d**) which serves for a stationary fixing to the respective telescopic element (**2, 40**), can be applied to the telescopic element which having the supporting rail with the rail channel or the sliding rail (**15, 16, 43, 44**) with the rail channel (**28, 29**).

15. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 1, further comprising at least one third elongated telescopic element (**40**) is an intermediate element (**40a**).

16. The telescopic guide according to claim 15, wherein the intermediate element (**40a**) comprises a sliding rail (**43, 44**) which cooperates with the supporting rail (**13, 14**) of the base element (**2a**) and a supporting rail (**45, 46**) which cooperates with the sliding rail (**15, 16**) of the end element (**3a, 73a, 76a**).

17. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 15, wherein the telescopic elements (**2, 3, 40**) are in each case formed as a double rail, and in that the double rail has two parallel supporting rails (**13, 14, 45, 46**) and/or two parallel sliding rails (**15, 16, 43, 44**).

18. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 17, wherein for the intermediate element (**40a**) formed as a double rail, two double rails are arranged one above the other, of which one is designed with parallel sliding rails (**43, 44**) and is facing towards the base element (**2a**) and the other is designed with parallel supporting rails (**45, 46**) and is facing towards the end element (**3a**).

19. The telescopic guide according to claim 17, wherein, in the case of a double rail, a lateral guiding can be brought about in each case between one of the parallel rails (supporting rail or sliding rail) and the corresponding plain bearing bodies (**51, 61**), whereas a lateral play (**S1**) is provided between the plain bearing bodies of the other of the parallel rails.

20. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 1, wherein the base element (**2a, 72a, 74a**) is provided with a stand (**6**).

21. The telescopic guide according to claim 1, wherein the base element (**2a**) has two side elements (**9, 10, 9', 10'**), and in that the side elements have a height which is sufficient to enclose the telescopic element(s) (**3a, 40a**) arranged above them laterally.

22. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 21, wherein at least one of the side elements is formed as a closed side wall (**9, 10, 9', 10'**).

23. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 1, wherein the end element (**3a, 73a, 76a**) has a mounting plane (**30**) for any attachments.

24. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 23, wherein the mounting plane (**30**) is a closed mounting surface (**30a**).

25. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 1, wherein at least one of the telescopic elements (**2, 3, 40, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76**) is formed in a single piece.

26. The telescopic guide (**1**) according to claim 1, wherein the sleeve-shaped plain bearing bodies (**51, 61**), with the lateral opening (**53, 63**), are produced from plastic.
